

ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES **ASSIGNMENT-2**

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A LIST OF FLORA AND FAUNA POPULATING SHIV NADAR UNIVERSITY, CHENNAI

ZONE: IN AND AROUND THE GENTS' HOSTEL



#1: Yellow-spotted Assassin Bug (Corsair Bug)

Regional Names: *Kolaiyali Poochi*, *Vandu*

Latin Name: *Acanthaspis quinquespinosa* (Family: *Reduviidae*)

Category: Insect

Location where observed: Gents Hostel 8

Habitat: Found in tropical foliage, leaf litter, under stones or loose tree bark, and frequently attracted to artificial outdoor lights near human settlements.



#2: American Cockroach

Regional Names: *Karappan Poochi*, *Paachai*

Latin Name: *Periplaneta americana*

Category: Insect

Location where observed: Gents Hostel 4

Habitat: Warm, dark, and humid environments, including basements, drains, pipes, bathrooms, and urban buildings worldwide.

#3: Variegated Golden Screw Pine

Regional Names: *Manjal Alangara Thazhai*, *Thazhai*

Latin Name: *Pandanus baptistii* 'Aureovariegatus'

Category: Plant

Location where observed: Gents Hostel 8

Habitat: Native to the South Pacific islands; commonly cultivated in tropical gardens, parks, and landscapes worldwide as an ornamental shrub.



#4: Red-legged Millipede / Rusty-legged Millipede

Regional Names: *Maravattai*

Latin Name: *Xystodesmidae* (or) *Trigoniulus corallinus* (Order: *Spirobolida*)

Category: Myriapod

Location where observed: Gents Hostel 1

Habitat: Damp soil, leaf litter, decaying wood, compost heaps, and shaded garden areas across tropical and subtropical Asia.





#5: Common Orb-weaver Spider

Regional Names: *Silanthi*

Latin Name: *Araneus spp. / Neoscona spp.* (Family: *Araneidae*)

Category: Arachnid

Location where observed: Gents Hostel 2

Habitat: Gardens, foliage, forest edges, and outdoor structures near lights, where they build classic wheel-shaped orb webs to catch flying insects.



#6: Indian Pariah Dog (Free-ranging / Street Dog)

Regional Names: *Naai, Theru Naai*

Latin Name: *Canis lupus familiaris*

Category: Mammal

Location where observed: Gents Hostel 9

Habitat: Urban and rural settlements, college campuses, streets, and human habitations across the Indian subcontinent.



#7: Red Cotton Stainer Bug / Red Cotton Bug

Regional Names: *Paruthi Sempoochi*

Latin Name: *Dysdercus cingulatus*

Category: Insect

Location where observed: Gents Hostel 7

Habitat: Gardens, agricultural fields, and forest edges, particularly near plants of the family Malvaceae (such as cotton, hibiscus, and okra).



#8: Jungle Babbler

Regional Names: *Thavittu Kuruvi, Aarandi*

Latin Name: *Argya striata*

Category: Bird

Location where observed: Hostel Lawn

Habitat: Deciduous forests, scrublands, overgrown gardens, urban parks, and campus grounds; usually seen foraging on the ground in social groups ("Seven Sisters").



#9: Domestic Cat

Regional Names: *Poonai*

Latin Name: *Felis catus*

Category: Mammal

Location where observed: Gents Hostel 3

Habitat: Urban, suburban, and rural areas, living near human settlements and college campuses.



#10: Indian Peafowl (Peafowl / Peahen)

Regional Names: *Mayil*

Latin Name: *Pavo cristatus*

Category: Bird

Location where observed: ECE Road

Habitat: Open forests, scrublands, agricultural fields, urban parks, and green educational campuses across South Asia.



#11: Copperpod Tree (Yellow Flame Tree)

Regional Names: *Iyalvagai*, *Manjal Konrai*

Latin Name: *Peltophorum pterocarpum*

Category: Plant

Location where observed: Near the Main Canteen

Habitat: Native to tropical Indo-Malaya and northern Australia; widely planted as an ornamental shade tree along roads, avenues, and parks.



#12: Bonnet Macaque

Regional Names: *Kurangu*

Latin Name: *Macaca radiata*

Category: Mammal

Location where observed: Gents Hostel 5

Habitat: Endemic to southern India, found in dry deciduous forests, rainforest edges, temples, agricultural areas, and urban spaces like college campuses.



#13: Plumeria / Frangipani (Temple Tree)

Regional Names: *Perungkalli*, *Shenbagam* / *Arali*

Latin Name: *Plumeria rubra* / *Plumeria alba*

Category: Plant

Location where observed: Entrance Lawn

Habitat: Native to tropical America; widely cultivated across tropical regions worldwide in gardens, parklands, and temple grounds for its fragrant, colorful blossoms.



#14: Singapore Graveyard Flower (White Frangipani)

Regional Names: *Savakkalli*, *Ven Arali*

Latin Name: *Plumeria obtusa*

Category: Plant

Location where observed: Vama Sundari Park

Habitat: Often found near coastal areas, in gardens, and commonly in graveyards in Southeast Asia.



#14: Rain Tree

Regional Names: *Thoongumoonji Maram* *Semmayirkkonrai*

Latin Name: *Samanea saman*

Category: Plant

Location where observed: Justice Prathap Auditorium Premises

Habitat: Common in tropical landscapes, often planted as a street or park shade tree.

FOOD CHAINS IN THE SNUC ECOSYSTEM

- **Producer:** Plants & Foliage (Pandanus / Garden Shrubs) – Convert solar energy into biomass through photosynthesis.
- **Primary Consumer:** Red Bugs (Dysdercus) & Cockroach – Herbivores and detritivores that feed directly on plant sap, seeds, and decaying organic foliage.
- **Secondary Consumer:** Orb-Weaver Spider – Carnivorous invertebrate that traps and feeds on primary consumers like bugs, flies, and smaller insects.
- **Tertiary Consumer:** Jungle Babbler – Foraging bird that hunts spiders, bugs, and small invertebrates beneath shrubbery.
- **Top Predator:** Domestic Cat / Stray Dog – Urban apex carnivores occupying the top trophic level, preying on birds, rodents, and smaller animals.
- **Extended Food Web Interactions:**

Bonnet Macaque & Peahen: Operate flexibly as Primary and Secondary Consumers (omnivores) by feeding on seeds, fruits, leaves, as well as small insects and spiders.

SAMPLE FOOD CHAIN



PRODUCER



PRIMARY CONSUMER



PRIMARY CONSUMER



SECONDARY CONSUMER



TERTIARY CONSUMER



PREDATOR